

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH LICENSURE
STATE OF OKLAHOMA

**STATE OF OKLAHOMA, ex rel,
STATE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL
HEALTH LICENSURE,**

Petitioner.

Complaint No. 23-LPC-400

vs.

**Michael Reynolds
LPC, LICENSE NO. 6103**

Respondent.



CONSENT ORDER

COMES NOW the State of Oklahoma, ex rel. the State Board of Behavioral Health Licensure ("the Board") by and through its attorney, Liz Stevens, Assistant Attorney General, and Michael Reynolds ("Respondent"), and hereby enter into this Consent Order, pursuant to 59 O.S. §1912(A) of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act, 86-10-29-3(b)(2)(C) of the Oklahoma Administrative Code, and 75 O.S. §309(E) of the Administrative Procedures Act. For the purposes of this Consent Order, the following facts are hereby stipulated to by the parties and adopted by the Board:

STIPULATION OF FACTS

1. Respondent is a Licensed Professional Counselor in the State of Oklahoma, holding License Number 6103 and was licensed on or about May 2, 2016.
2. On June 28, 2023, Respondent pled Guilty to one (1) count of Medicaid Fraud in violation of 56 O.S. § 1005(A)(1) and one (1) count of Identity Theft in violation of 21 O.S. 1533.1(B), Oklahoma County case number CF-2022-1315.
3. Respondent was sentenced to a 10-year deferred sentence, prevented from billing

Medicaid for duration of sentence and ordered to pay restitution and other costs.

4. The offer of proof for the Guilty plea states that "In OK Co. between 4-28-15-11-19-19 I committed Medicaid fraud in the total amount of more than \$2500 by making false claims for [payments] on work not done & committed identity theft by using the identities of 35 Medicaid recipients w/ fraudulent intent."

5. In order to resolve all issues raised in the Request for Inquiry filed in this matter, the parties agree to the below Agreed Conclusions of Law and Agreed Order.

AGREED CONCLUSIONS OF LAW

1. The Board has jurisdiction over this matter and Respondent pursuant to 59 O.S. §1905(B)(4) of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act.

2. Pursuant to 59 O.S. §1912(A)(5) of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act, the Board has the authority to deny, revoke, suspend, or place on probation any license if that license holder has engaged in unprofessional conduct.

3. Pursuant to 59 O.S. §1913.1(B), the Board has the authority to impose an administrative penalty not to exceed ten thousand dollars (\$10,000) on any person who is determined to have violated any provision of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act or any rule promulgated, or order issued pursuant thereto.

4. Respondent agrees that he did not comply with the Licensed Professional Counselor Act nor the Oklahoma Administrative Code. Respondent violated the following:

86:10-3-4. Professional Standards

(a) **Violations of other laws.** It shall be unprofessional conduct for an LPC to plead guilty to or no contest to or be convicted of a state or federal felony crime if the violation substantially relates to the practice of counseling and poses a reasonable threat to public

saretv

AGREED ORDER

The Board and Respondent agree to the following Order:

1. Respondent shall surrender his LPC license.
2. Respondent shall not reapply for a LPC license for a for a period of at least two (2) Years from the date of license surrender.
3. Respondent understands and agrees that should any future instances be brought to the attention of the Board in which Respondent has violated the Licensed Professional Counselor Act or the Oklahoma Administrative Code, the Board reserves the right to prosecute such violations and to consider this Consent Order as a factor in the determination of any sanctions and penalties, if any, should the Board determine that any violation has occurred.
4. Failure to comply with any of the terms of this Order may result in further disciplinary action against Respondent, including, but not limited to, the suspension or revocation of Respondent's license.

PUBLIC RECORD

Respondent acknowledges that once adopted by the Board, this Consent Order and all associated documentation becomes a matter of public record, unless otherwise excluded by law.

ACCEPTANCE BY BOARD

This Consent Order will not be submitted for Board consideration until it has been agreed to and executed by Respondent. The Consent Order shall not become effective until it has been approved by a majority of the Board and endorsed by a representative of the Board.

It is hereby agreed between the parties that this Consent Order shall be presented to the Board with a recommendation of approval from the Board at the Board Meeting scheduled for April 12, 2024. Respondent understands that the Board is free to accept or reject this Consent

Order and, if rejected by the Board, a formal disciplinary hearing on the Complaint against Respondent may be held.

If the Consent Order is not accepted by the Board, it shall be regarded as null and void. Admissions by Respondent in the Consent Order will not be regarded as evidence against him at the subsequent disciplinary hearing. Respondent will be free to defend herself and no inferences will be made from his willingness to have entered into this agreement. It is agreed that neither the presentation of the Consent Order nor the Board's consideration of the Consent Order will be deemed to have unfairly or illegally prejudiced the Board or its individual members and therefore will not be grounds for precluding the Board or any individual Board member from further participation in proceedings related to the matters set forth in this Consent Order.

VOLUNTARY WAIVER OF RIGHTS

Respondent is fully aware of his rights to contest the allegations pending against him. Respondent acknowledges these rights include: representation by an attorney at his own expense; the right to a public hearing on any charges or allegations filed; the right to confront and cross-examine witnesses called to testify against him; the right to present evidence on his own behalf; the right to compulsory process to secure attendance of such witnesses; the right to testify on his own behalf; the right to receive written findings of fact and conclusions of law supporting the decision on the merits of the Complaint and the right to obtain judicial review of the Board's decision. Respondent in exchange for the Board's acceptance of this Consent Order voluntarily waives all of these rights.

COMPLETE AGREEMENT

This Consent Order consists of six (6) pages and embodies the entire agreement between the Board and Respondent. It may not be altered and modified without the express consent of the parties.


AMY BARNETT, LPC CC Board Member

Dated this 12th day of April, 2024.

IT IS SO ORDERED.

STATE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH LICENSURE

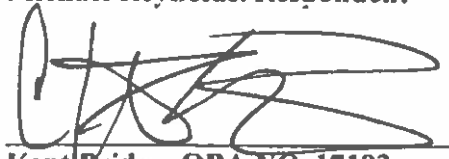

BOARD MEMBER

Dated this 12 day of April, 2024.

I have read the entirety of this Consent Order. I understand that by its terms I waive certain rights accorded me under Oklahoma law. I agree to this Consent Order:


Michael Reynolds, Respondent

Dated this 5 day of April, 2024.


Kent Bridge, OBA NO. 17193
Attorney for Respondent

Dated this 5 day of April, 2024.

CERTIFICATION OF BOARD ATTORNEY

I believe this Consent Order to be in the best interests of the State Board of Behavioral Health Licensure and the State of Oklahoma for the violations as outlined in the foregoing

Consent Order.


LIZ STEVENS. OBA NO. 34185

Dated this 12 day of April, 2024.

Assistant Attorney General
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**ATTORNEY FOR THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA
STATE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH**